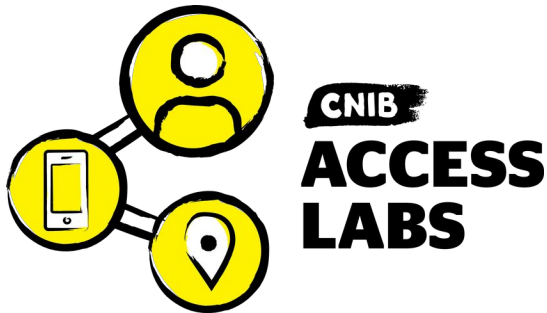


Auto A11y User Guide

Desktop Application User Manual

CNIB Access Labs

July 2026



Auto A11y is a web accessibility testing platform. It crawls websites, runs hundreds of automated WCAG checks in a real browser, adds AI-powered visual analysis, tests PDFs, and produces reports ranging from a one-page executive summary to a complete offline audit package.

This guide walks through the desktop application using a real example project — **Inaccessibility Matters**, a deliberately inaccessible demonstration site — so every screenshot shows genuine test data.



Contents

1. [An introduction to accessibility testing](#)
2. [How Auto A11y works](#)
3. [The Dashboard](#)
4. [Creating and configuring a project](#)
5. [Choosing which tests to run](#)
6. [Automated checks versus AI analysis](#)
7. [Responsive breakpoint testing](#)
8. [Websites and page discovery](#)
9. [Cloaking: getting past bot protection](#)
10. [Test users: content behind logins](#)
11. [Setup scripts and multi-state testing](#)
12. [Running tests](#)
13. [Reading test results](#)
14. [Testing PDFs](#)
15. [Reports](#)
16. [Scheduling recurring tests](#)
17. [The Testing menu](#)
18. [Tips, accessibility features, and troubleshooting](#)
19. [Appendix A: Tests by touchpoint](#)



1 An introduction to accessibility testing

Web accessibility means building websites that everyone can use, including people who are blind or have low vision, are deaf or hard of hearing, have motor impairments that make a mouse difficult, or have cognitive disabilities. The international standard is the **Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG)**, organized into success criteria at three conformance levels: A, AA (the common legal target), and AAA.

No single technique catches every accessibility barrier. Auto A11y combines several complementary kinds of testing, and understanding what each can and cannot do is the key to using the tool well.

- **Automated DOM testing.** Hundreds of programmatic checks run against the page’s structure in a real browser — missing alt text, form fields with no label, invalid ARIA, heading levels that skip. This is fast, exact, and repeatable, but it can only find problems a machine can be *certain* about. It cannot tell you whether alt text is *meaningful*, only whether it exists.
- **AI visual analysis.** Some barriers are only visible in the rendered page: text that *looks* like a heading but isn’t marked up as one, a reading order that doesn’t match the visual layout, an animation with no pause control. Auto A11y sends page screenshots to Claude AI to catch these — judgment calls that DOM inspection structurally cannot make.
- **Manual review (Discovery).** Some things a tool can only *flag* for a human to judge: does this video have accurate captions? Is this form’s error handling clear? Auto A11y surfaces these as **Discovery** items and collects them in a dedicated report so a human reviewer knows exactly where to look.
- **Lived-experience testing.** The ultimate test is a person with a disability using the site. Auto A11y can ingest recordings of these sessions and compile their findings alongside the automated results.
- **Document testing.** Accessibility doesn’t stop at HTML. Auto A11y audits **PDF** documents against PDF/UA and WCAG.

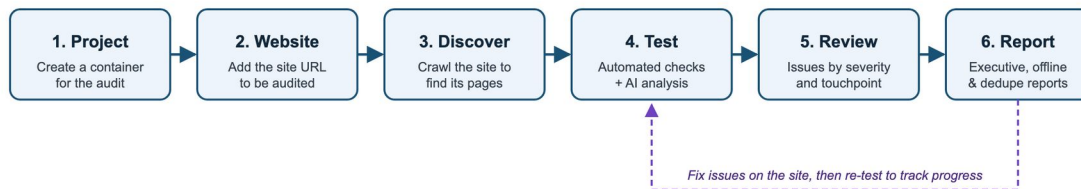
A complete audit uses all of these. Automated testing tells you *where* the obvious problems are and gives you a baseline to track over time; AI and manual review find what automation misses; lived experience confirms whether the site actually works for real users. This guide covers each part.

Why the tool won’t give you a “100% accessible” stamp. Automated testing can prove a site *fails*, but it can never prove a site *passes* — roughly half of WCAG criteria require human judgment. A clean automated result means “no machine-detectable violations,” which is necessary but not sufficient. Treat the score as a floor, not a certificate.



2 How Auto A11y works

The workflow is a loop: set up a project, find the pages, test them, review what was found, report — then fix the site and re-test to track progress.



Workflow: 1 Project, 2 Website, 3 Discover, 4 Test, 5 Review, 6 Report, with a feedback loop from Report back to Test labelled “Fix issues on the site, then re-test to track progress”

Everything you test lives in a simple hierarchy: a **project** contains **websites**, each website contains **pages** (and PDFs), and every page keeps its own history of **test results**.



Data model: a Project contains Websites, which contain Pages, which accumulate Test Results grouped by touchpoint and severity. Side panels describe the automated JavaScript checks (fixture-validated) and Claude AI visual analysis.

Issues are graded by **severity**:

Severity	Meaning
Error	A WCAG violation that must be fixed
Warning	A likely barrier that should be reviewed
Info	Worth noting; not necessarily a defect
Discovery	Content the automation found that needs



Severity	Meaning
	<i>manual</i> review (forms, videos, PDFs, complex widgets)

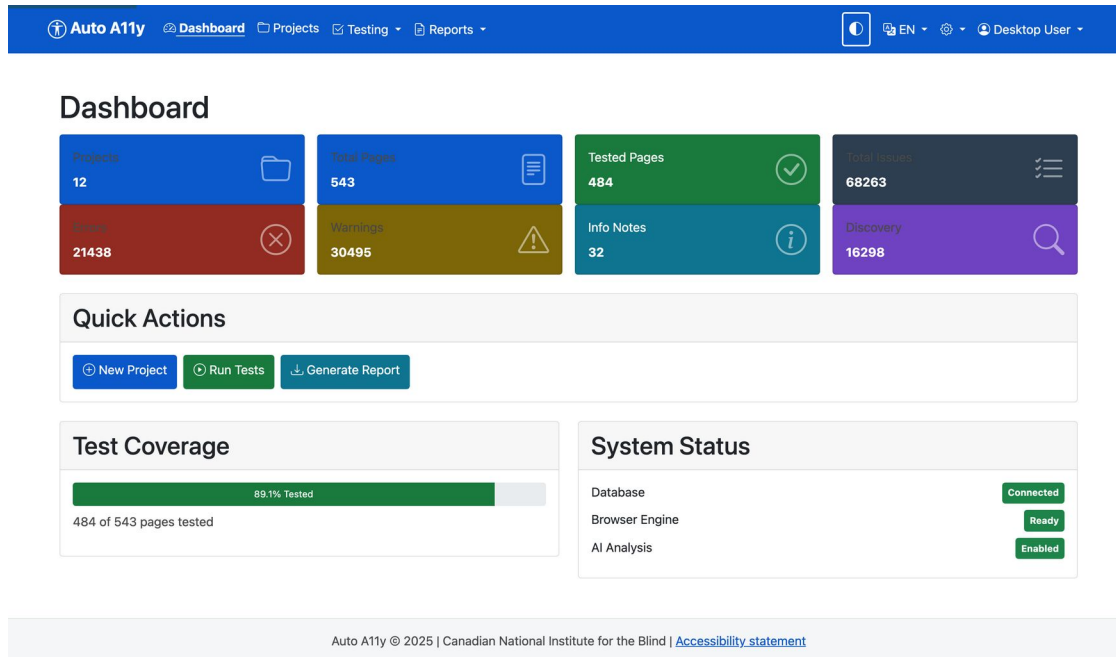
and organized by **touchpoint** — the category of accessibility concern (Forms, Headings, Landmarks, Colors and Contrast, Focus Management, and so on). Touchpoints map to the relevant WCAG success criteria in every report, and they are also how you choose what to test (see [section 5](#)).

A quality gate protects you from false positives: each automated check is validated against a library of known test cases (“fixtures”), and **only checks that pass all of their fixtures are enabled**. You can see exactly which checks are active under *Testing* → *Fixture Status*, and the full list is in [Appendix A](#).



3 The Dashboard

The Dashboard is the landing page: portfolio-wide statistics, quick actions, test coverage, and system status.



Dashboard showing stat tiles (Projects 12, Total Pages 543, Tested Pages 484, Total Issues 68263, Errors, Warnings, Info Notes, Discovery), Quick Actions buttons (New Project, Run Tests, Generate Report), a Test Coverage bar at 89.1%, and System Status showing Database Connected, Browser Engine Ready, AI Analysis Enabled

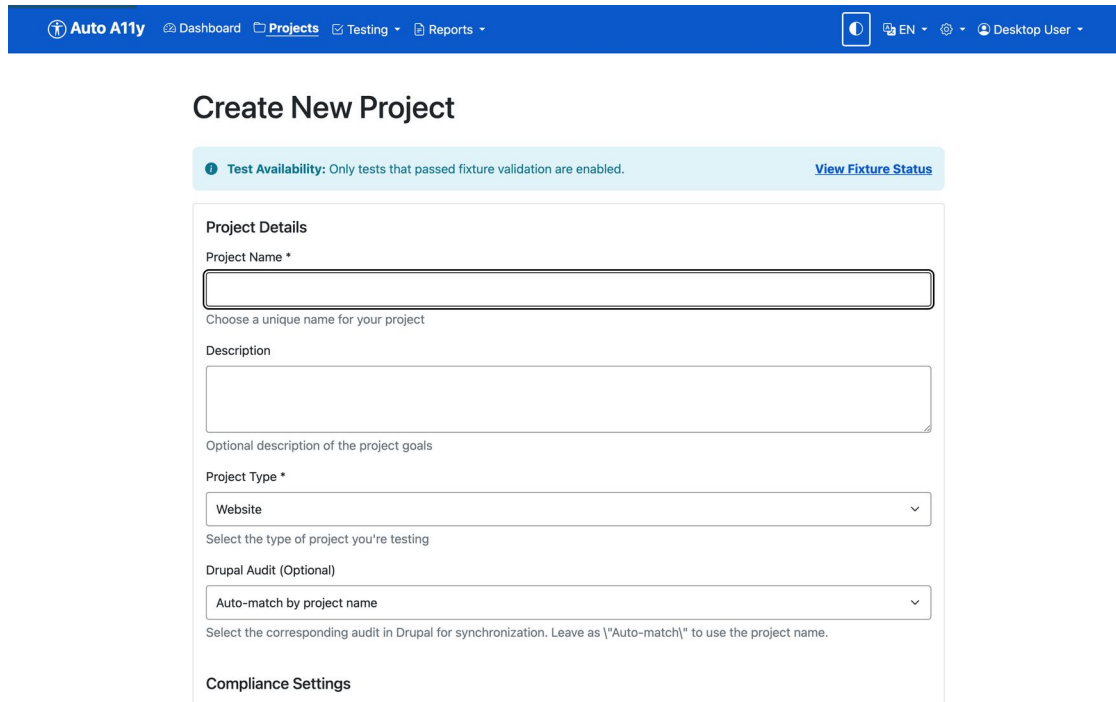
- **Stat tiles** — totals across all projects: pages, tested pages, and issues broken down by severity.
- **Quick Actions** — jump straight to creating a project, running tests, or generating a report.
- **Test Coverage** — how much of your page inventory has been tested.
- **System Status** — the database, browser engine, and AI analysis must all be green for testing to run.

The top navigation is always available: **Dashboard**, **Projects**, **Testing** (dashboard, configuration, fixture status, trends), and **Reports**, plus the dark-mode toggle, language switcher (English/French), and settings on the right.



4 Creating and configuring a project

A project is the container for one audit engagement — its websites, test settings, WCAG level, test users, and reports. From **Projects** in the navigation, click **New Project**.



The screenshot shows the 'Create New Project' form in the Auto A11y application. The top navigation bar is blue with links for 'Auto A11y', 'Dashboard', 'Projects', 'Testing', and 'Reports'. On the right, there are icons for a user profile, language (EN), and a desktop user. The form itself is titled 'Create New Project' and has a light blue header with a message: 'Test Availability: Only tests that passed fixture validation are enabled.' and a link 'View Fixture Status'. The form is divided into sections: 'Project Details' with fields for 'Project Name *' (a text input) and 'Description' (a text area), followed by 'Project Type *' (a dropdown menu with 'Website' selected) and 'Drupal Audit (Optional)' (a dropdown menu with 'Auto-match by project name' selected). Below these is a 'Compliance Settings' section. A small note under the Project Type dropdown says 'Select the type of project you're testing'. Another note under the Drupal Audit dropdown says 'Select the corresponding audit in Drupal for synchronization. Leave as \"Auto-match\" to use the project name.'

Create New Project form with Project Name, Description, Project Type fields and a Compliance Settings section. A banner notes that only tests that passed fixture validation are enabled.

The form is longer than it first appears — scroll down and you configure the entire testing behaviour for the project up front:

- **Project Name** (required) and **Description**.
- **Project Type** — Website is the default.
- **Compliance Settings** — the **WCAG level** you're testing against (A, AA, or AAA). AA is the usual target.
- **Inaccessible Fonts** — the tool flags hard-to-read fonts. You can use the research-backed default list of 50+ problematic fonts (Comic Sans, Papyrus, narrow and blackletter faces), add your own, or exclude specific fonts your brand requires.
- **Browser Display Mode** — Headless (invisible, faster) or Visible (shows the Chrome window, useful for debugging).
- **Stealth Mode** — for bot-protected sites (see [section 9](#)).
- **Touchpoint Tests** — exactly which checks run (see [section 5](#)).
- **AI-Assisted Testing** — the optional Claude analysis (see [section 6](#)).



[Projects](#)
[Inaccessibility Matters 2](#)
Automated Tests

Automated Tests

Upload to Drupal

Filters

Page URLs

All Pages
Inaccessibility Matters - About us
Español
Untitled
Untitled

Hold Ctrl/Cmd to select multiple

WCAG Success Criteria

All WCAG Criteria

Hold Ctrl/Cmd to select multiple

Apply Filters
 Clear Filters

Touchpoints

All Touchpoints

Hold Ctrl/Cmd to select multiple

Impact Level

All Impact Levels
Critical
High
Medium
Low

Hold Ctrl/Cmd to select multiple

Total: 5 pages with 696 issues

Test Results

Lower half of the project form showing Browser Display Mode set to Headless, an unchecked “Enable Stealth Mode (for Cloudflare-protected sites)” checkbox with a note that it slows testing 5-15 seconds per page, the Touchpoint Tests section with Enable All / Disable All / Minimal / WCAG AA preset buttons, and the AI-Assisted Testing toggle noting it incurs API costs

Every setting here can be changed later by opening the project and clicking **Edit**, or, for the test selection specifically, **Automated Tests**.

4.1 The project page

Once created, opening a project shows everything in one place:

Auto A11y Dashboard Projects Testing Reports

EN Desktop User

Inaccessibility Matters 2 Active

No description

Test All Websites Test Users Participants Automated Tests Edit Delete

Websites 1	Documents 5 5 pages + 0 PDFs	Tested 5 100.0% coverage	Issues 387 300 warnings
----------------------	---	---------------------------------------	--------------------------------------

PDFs 0

Websites Add Website

Main 387 issues 300 warnings

<https://bobjd69.sg-host.com/>

5 pages 2026-07-21 08:31

View Discover Test

Discovered Pages

Project page for Inaccessibility Matters 2 showing action buttons (Test All Websites, Test Users, Participants, Automated Tests, Edit, Delete), stat cards (Websites 1, Documents 5, Tested 5 at 100% coverage, Issues 387 with 300 warnings), and the Websites list with View, Discover, and Test buttons

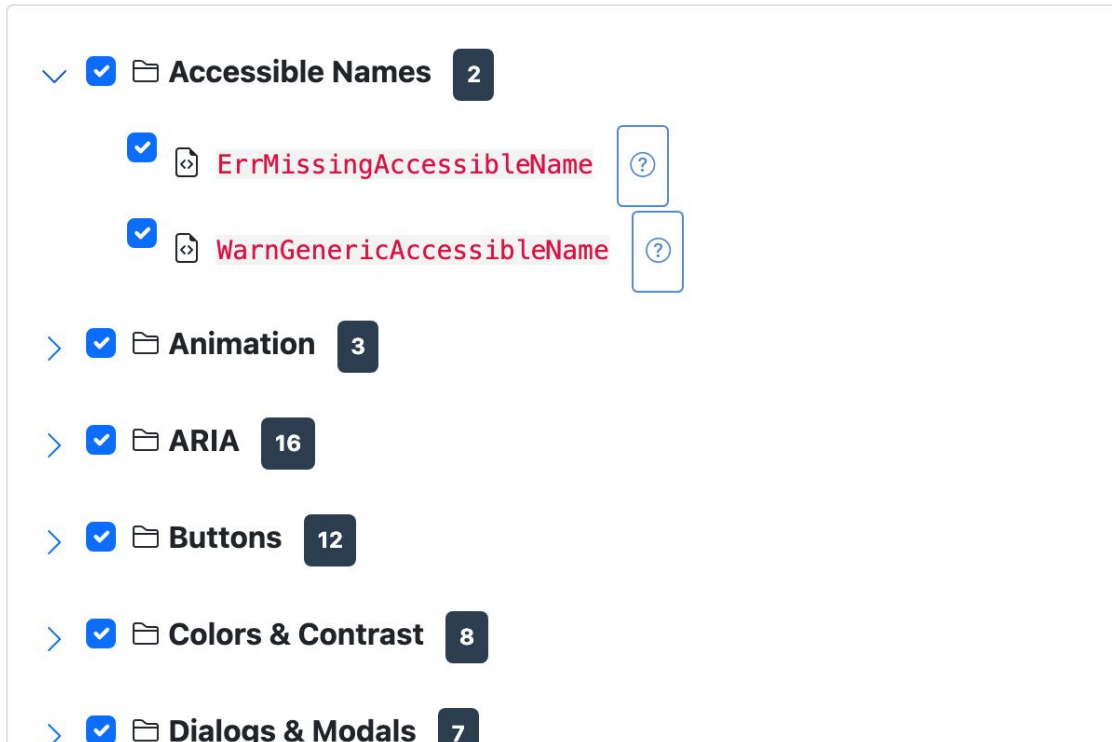
- **Test All Websites** starts a test run over every website in the project.
- **Test Users** manages logins for authenticated testing ([section 10](#)).
- **Automated Tests** re-opens the touchpoint/test selection.
- The **Websites** card lists each site with its issue counts and per-site **View** / **Discover** / **Test** buttons.



5 Choosing which tests to run

You rarely want *every* check on *every* project. A marketing site has no data tables; an internal tool may not care about some discovery notices. Auto A11y lets you choose what runs at two levels of granularity: the **touchpoint** (a whole category) and the **individual test** within it.

In the project form (or via **Automated Tests / Edit** later), the **Touchpoint Tests** section presents a tree. Each touchpoint is a folder you can expand to reveal its individual checks; each check has its own checkbox.



Touchpoint test tree with Accessible Names expanded to show its two checks (ErrMissingAccessibleName and WarnGenericAccessibleName), each with a checkbox and a help button, followed by collapsed touchpoints Animation (3), ARIA (16), Buttons (12), Colors & Contrast (8), and Dialogs & Modals (7), each showing its test count

- **The number badge** on each touchpoint shows how many checks it contains.
- **Uncheck a touchpoint** to skip the whole category; **expand it** and uncheck individual tests to fine-tune.
- **The help button** (question mark) next to each test opens a description of what it checks and why.
- **Presets** save time: **Enable All**, **Disable All**, **Minimal** (a core subset), and **WCAG AA** (everything needed for AA conformance).



Checks that haven't passed fixture validation appear disabled with a status badge — they can't be enabled because they aren't trusted for production yet. The complete catalog of checks, grouped by touchpoint, is in [Appendix A](#).



6 Automated checks versus AI analysis

Auto A11y has two independent testing engines, and the difference between them matters for both cost and interpretation.

Automated (default) checks are deterministic. They run JavaScript against the page in a real browser and apply exact rules: this input has no label, this image has no alt attribute, these two colors fall below the contrast threshold. Given the same page, they return the same result every time. They are free to run, fast, and form the backbone of every test.

AI-assisted checks send page screenshots and HTML to Claude AI for analysis that requires visual judgment. Six analyses are available:

AI check	What it looks for
Heading analysis	Text that looks like a heading but isn't marked up as one
Reading order	Whether the DOM order matches the visual reading sequence
Modal dialogs	Popup and overlay accessibility (focus, dismissal)
Language	Mixed languages and missing language declarations
Animations	Motion that may need a pause/stop control
Interactive elements	Buttons, links, and controls that look interactive but aren't properly coded

AI testing is **off by default** and enabled per project with the **AI-Assisted Testing** toggle, where you also pick which of the six analyses to run.

Two things to understand before you rely on it:

AI testing costs money. Each AI analysis makes an API call to Claude that is billed by usage. The more pages you test and the more AI checks you enable, the higher the cost. Automated DOM checks have no such cost — enable AI deliberately, not by default.

And, just as importantly:

AI results are stochastic. Unlike the deterministic automated checks, an AI model can return slightly different results on different runs of the same page, and it can occasionally be wrong — a missed issue, or a flagged “issue” that isn't one. This is inherent to how large language models work, even with the prompting and validation Auto A11y applies. Treat AI findings as expert suggestions to verify, not as ground truth. The automated checks remain your reliable, repeatable baseline.



Used together they're complementary: the automated engine gives you a solid, repeatable foundation, and AI extends coverage into areas no rule-based tool can reach — as long as you remember which is which.



7 Responsive breakpoint testing

Modern sites change layout at different screen widths using CSS “media queries” — the point where the layout changes is a **breakpoint**. An issue can exist at one width and not another: text that has good contrast on desktop may sit on a different background colour once the mobile layout kicks in; a floating element may overlap content only when the viewport is narrow.

For the checks where width matters — **colour contrast**, **floating/obscured content**, and some **page-level** checks — Auto A11y doesn’t just test once. It reads the breakpoints declared in the page’s own CSS, then re-runs the check at **each** of those widths, so a contrast failure that only appears in the tablet layout is still caught. In the results, these issues are labelled with the specific breakpoint (e.g. “Breakpoint 768px”) so you know exactly which layout to fix.

Checks where width is irrelevant (a missing alt attribute is missing at every width) run once, so this adds testing time only where it actually buys coverage.



8 Websites and page discovery

Open a website from the project page to manage its pages and testing.

The screenshot shows the Auto A11y web application interface. At the top is a blue navigation bar with the 'Auto A11y' logo and links to Dashboard, Projects, Testing, and Reports. The main content area is titled 'Main' and shows the URL 'https://bobd69.sg-host.com/'. Below the URL are three buttons: 'Discover Pages', 'Test All Documents', and 'Test Untested Documents'. A row of tabs includes 'Discovery History', 'Documents', 'Setup Scripts', 'Test Users', 'Schedules', 'Reports', and 'Edit'. A 'Manual mode' section contains instructions and four buttons: 'Start visible browser', 'Capture this page', 'Test this page', and 'Stop session'. Below this are four stat cards: 'Total Documents' (6), 'Tested' (6), 'Violations' (476), and 'Warnings' (377). At the bottom, there is a 'PDFs' section with a count of 0, and a 'Pages (6)' section with an 'Add Page' button.

Website page for “Main” showing Discover Pages, Test All Documents, and Test Untested Documents buttons; a Manual mode panel with Start visible browser, Capture this page, Test this page, and Stop session; stat cards (Total Documents 6, Tested 6, Violations 476, Warnings 377); and the Pages list with an Add Page button

8.1 Finding pages

There are three ways to build the page inventory:

1. **Discover Pages** — crawls the site automatically, following links to find pages. Discovery runs in the background; **Discovery History** shows past crawls.
2. **Add Page** — add a URL by hand (useful for pages the crawler can’t reach).
3. **Manual mode** — opens a *visible* Chromium window that you drive yourself. Navigate wherever you need — through logins, wizards, or dynamic states — then click **Capture this page** to add the current URL to the page list, or **Test this page** to run the test suite against exactly what is on screen.

The **Pages** list shows every page with its status (tested/untested), latest issue counts, and per-page actions.



Pages (6)

Add Page

<https://bobd69.sg-host.com/>

Tested

89 violations 77 warnings 2026-07-21 08:05

View Test

<https://bobd69.sg-host.com>

Tested

92 violations 78 warnings 2026-07-21 08:05

View Test

<https://bobd69.sg-host.com/about.html>

Tested

69 violations 55 warnings 2026-07-21 08:31

View Test

<https://bobd69.sg-host.com/a11y.html>

Tested

65 violations 38 warnings 2026-07-21 08:04

View Test

<https://bobd69.sg-host.com/Default.html>

Tested

Pages list on the website page, showing each page URL with status and issue counts



9 Cloaking: getting past bot protection

Many production sites sit behind bot-protection services such as Cloudflare. These services try to distinguish real browsers from automated ones and will challenge or block traffic they think is a bot — which an accessibility crawler technically is. When a site is protected this way, discovery and testing can fail with challenge pages instead of the real content.

Stealth Mode (the “cloaking” option) is Auto A11y’s answer. When enabled, the browser is disguised to look like an ordinary human-driven session — it hides the automation flags that bot-detectors look for (the `webdriver` marker, missing browser plugins, and similar tells) so the real page loads.

You enable it per project with the **Enable Stealth Mode (for Cloudflare-protected sites)** checkbox in the project form.

Only use stealth mode when you need it. The disguise adds significant overhead — roughly **5-15 seconds per page** — so discovery and testing run much more slowly. Leave it off for sites that don’t challenge the crawler, and turn it on only when you see bot-protection pages instead of your content. You should also have authorization to test the site; evading bot protection on a site you don’t control may violate its terms of service.

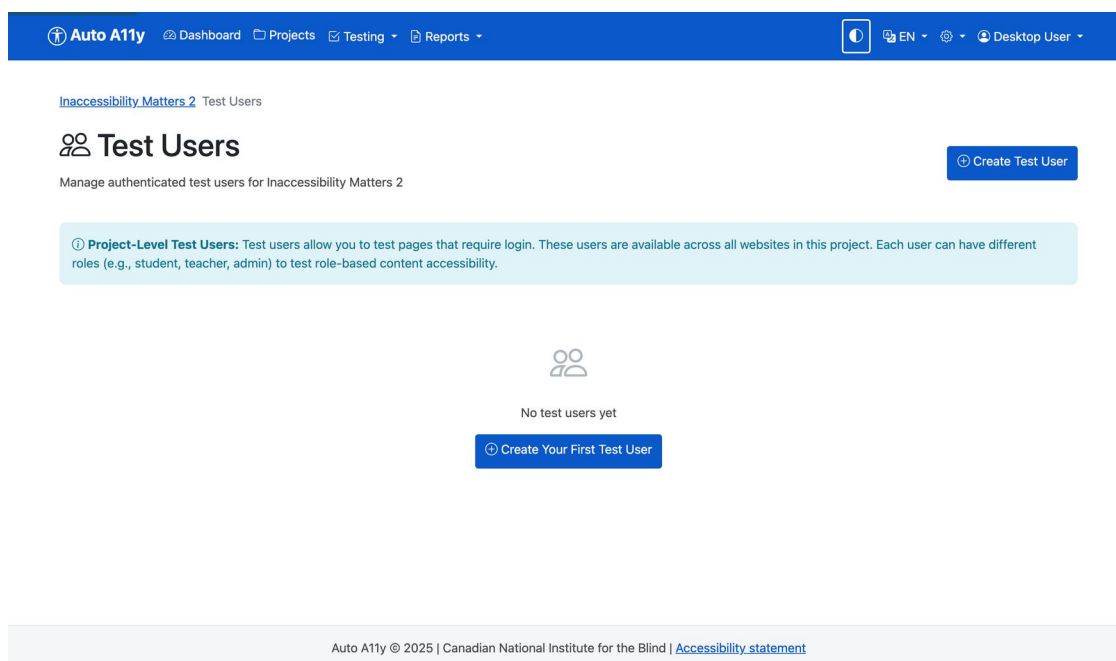


10 Test users: content behind logins

Much of a real application lives behind a login — a dashboard, an account page, a checkout. An unauthenticated crawler never sees it, so those pages go untested. Worse, what a user can see often depends on their **role**: a student and an instructor see different pages in a learning platform, an admin sees controls a regular user doesn't. Each of those views can have its own accessibility problems.

Test users solve both. A test user is a stored login credential that the test runner uses to sign in *before* testing, so authenticated pages are audited as that user would see them. Because a user carries **roles**, you can create one test user per role and test each role's version of the site.

Manage them from **Test Users** on the project page (they're shared across all the project's websites).



The screenshot shows the 'Test Users' page in the Auto A11y application. The top navigation bar is blue with links for 'Auto A11y', 'Dashboard', 'Projects', 'Testing', and 'Reports'. On the right, there are icons for a user profile, language (EN), and a 'Desktop User' dropdown. Below the navigation bar, the page title is 'Inaccessibility Matters 2 Test Users'. The main heading is 'Test Users' with a subtext 'Manage authenticated test users for Inaccessibility Matters 2'. A blue button labeled 'Create Test User' is in the top right. A light blue informational box contains the text: 'Project-Level Test Users: Test users allow you to test pages that require login. These users are available across all websites in this project. Each user can have different roles (e.g., student, teacher, admin) to test role-based content accessibility.' Below this, there is a placeholder for a user icon and the text 'No test users yet'. A blue button labeled 'Create Your First Test User' is at the bottom. The footer contains the text 'Auto A11y © 2025 | Canadian National Institute for the Blind | [Accessibility statement](#)'.

Test Users page explaining that test users allow testing pages that require login, are available across all websites in the project, and can have different roles (student, teacher, admin) to test role-based content accessibility, with a Create Test User button

When you create a test user you provide its credentials and choose an **authentication method**:

- **Form login** — the standard username/password form; you tell Auto A11y the login URL and which fields to fill.
- **HTTP Basic Auth** — the browser's built-in credential prompt.



- **Manual login** — for logins Auto A11y can't automate (two-factor codes, multi-step SSO), you sign in yourself once in a visible browser and the session is captured and reused.

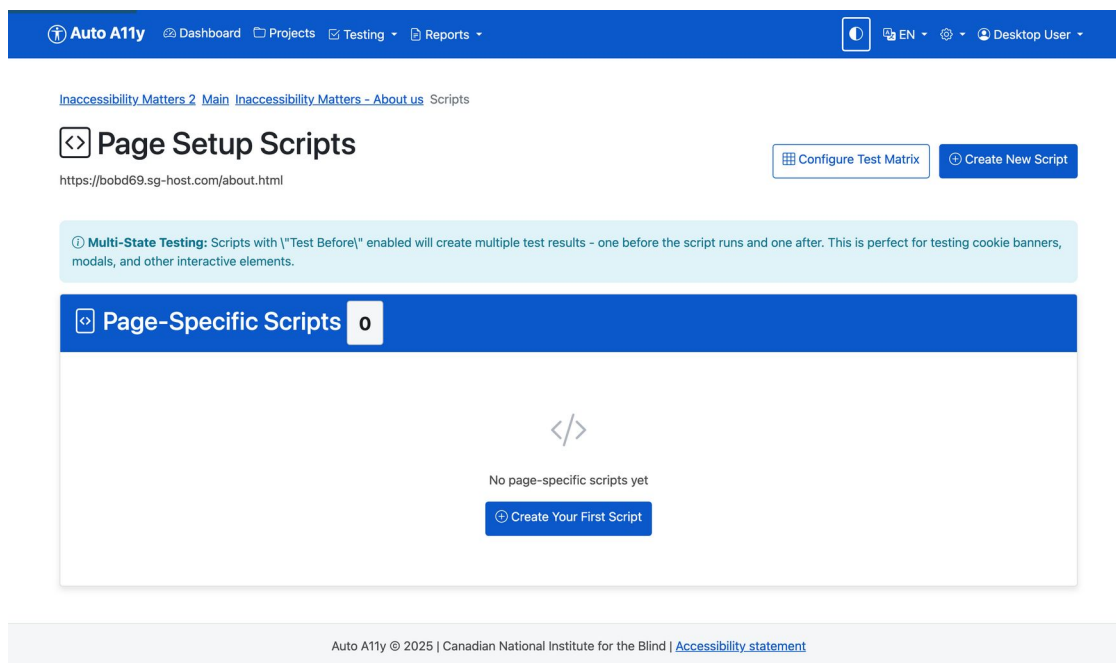
Each test user has a **Test Login** button that runs the login automation on its own, so you can confirm the credentials and selectors work before launching a full test run. In the results, every issue is labelled with the user context it was found under (you'll see "Guest" for unauthenticated tests), so role-specific problems are attributable to the role.



11 Setup scripts and multi-state testing

Sometimes the page you want to test isn't the page that first loads. A cookie banner covers the content until dismissed. A modal has to be opened. A tab has to be selected. A **setup script** is a short recorded sequence of actions that prepares the page before testing.

Scripts live on individual pages (and can also be defined website-wide). Open a page and choose **Scripts**, or use **Setup Scripts** on the website.



Page Setup Scripts screen with a “Multi-State Testing” info banner explaining that scripts with “Test Before” enabled create multiple test results (one before the script runs, one after), and a Create New Script button

A script is a list of **steps**, each one an action:

Step type	What it does
Click	Click a button or link (e.g. the cookie “Accept” button)
Type	Enter text into a field
Wait for element	Pause until a selector appears
Wait (fixed)	Pause for a set number of milliseconds
Wait for navigation / network idle	Pause until the page settles
Scroll, Hover, Select, Screenshot	Other page interactions



Elements are targeted with CSS selectors (a class like `.cookie-banner`, an id like `#accept-btn`, or an attribute selector). The script editor includes a Quick Help panel with common selector patterns and worked examples.

Create Page-Level Setup Script

What are Page-Level Scripts?
Scripts that prepare a specific page for testing (e.g., open modals, navigate tabs). With multi-state testing, you can test pages both before and after the script runs.

* Required field

Basic Information

Script Name *
e.g., Dismiss Cookie Banner
A descriptive name for this script

Description
Optional: Describe what this script does

☒ **Script Enabled**
Uncheck to disable this script without deleting it

Quick Help

Common Selectors

- `.cookie-banner` - Class name
- `#accept-btn` - ID
- `button[data-action="accept"]` - Attribute
- `.modal .close-button` - Nested

Step Types

- Click:** Click a button/link
- Type:** Enter text in field
- Wait for Element:** Wait until element appears
- Wait (Fixed):** Pause for X milliseconds

Examples

Cookie Banner:

- Wait for: `.cookie-banner`
- Click: `.accept-button`

Modal:

- Click: `#open-modal`
- Wait for: `.modal-dialog`

Multi-State Testing

Create Page-Level Setup Script form with a Script Name field (placeholder “e.g., Dismiss Cookie Banner”), Description, and Script Enabled checkbox; a Quick Help sidebar lists common selectors, the four main step types, and worked examples for a cookie banner and a modal

11.1 Multi-state testing: test before *and* after

Here’s the powerful part. A script has a **Test Before** option. With it enabled, a single test run produces **two** sets of results:

1. The page **before** the script runs — for a cookie banner, this is the page *with* the banner covering the content, so you catch any accessibility problems in the banner itself.
2. The page **after** the script runs — the banner dismissed, so you test the real underlying content that was hidden behind it.

Worked example — a cookie notice:

1. Create a script named “Dismiss Cookie Notice”.
2. Add a step: **Wait for element** `.cookie-banner`.
3. Add a step: **Click** `.cookie-banner .accept-button`.
4. Enable **Test Before**.
5. Run the test.



You now get one result for the banner-covered state and one for the banner-dismissed state, each with its own issue list, linked together and labelled with the state they represent (“Initial page state” and “After executing script: Dismiss Cookie Notice”). The same pattern works for testing a modal open versus closed, or any two states of the same page.



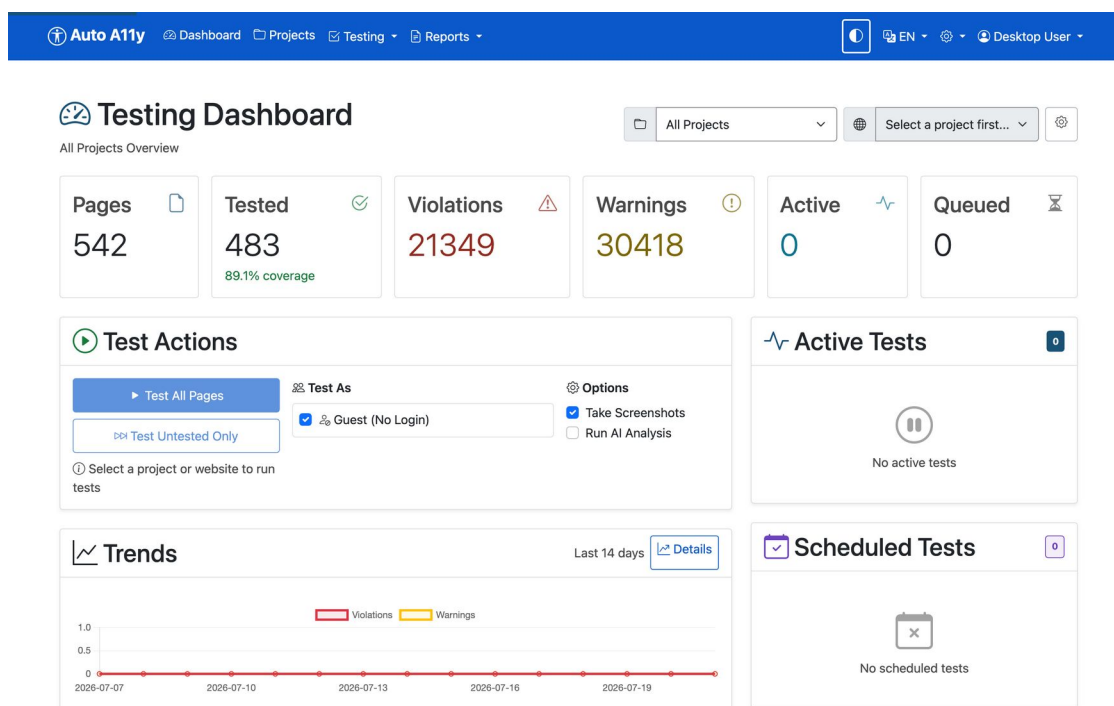
12 Running tests

You can start a test at any scope:

Where	Button	What runs
Project page	Test All Websites	Every page in every website
Website page	Test All Documents	Every page (and PDF) in the site
Website page	Test Untested Documents	Only pages without results
Page list / page view	Test	That single page

During a test, Auto A11y loads the page in a browser (signing in as a test user and running any setup scripts first), injects and runs the JavaScript check suite at each relevant breakpoint, captures a screenshot, and (when enabled) sends the screenshot to Claude AI for visual analysis. Results are saved to the page's history.

Tests run as background jobs; you can keep working while they run. Progress is visible on the page itself and under *Testing* → *Dashboard*.



Testing dashboard showing test activity and job status



13 Reading test results

Open any tested page to see its **Latest Test Results** — the heart of the product. Issues are grouped into severity sections (Errors, Warnings, Info, Discovery), then by touchpoint, then by issue type.

The screenshot displays the 'Auto A11y' web application interface. The top navigation bar is blue with links for 'Dashboard', 'Projects', 'Testing', and 'Reports'. The main content area shows the test results for the page 'Inaccessibility Matters - About us'. Key metrics include a 'Status' of 'Tested', a 'Priority' of 'Normal', a 'Last Tested' date of '2026-07-21 08:31', and a 'Test Duration' of '160.83s'. A 'Page Screenshot' is shown below these metrics. Two large score boxes are present: 'Automated Accessibility Score' at 62.9% (146 / 232 automated checks passed) and 'Automated WCAG Compliance Score' at 23.3% (7 / 30 automated tests passed). At the bottom, a section titled 'Accessibility Issues Found' is visible.

Status	Priority	Last Tested	Test Duration
Tested	Normal	2026-07-21 08:31	160.83s

Page Screenshot

Automated Accessibility Score **62.9%**
146 / 232 automated checks passed

Automated WCAG Compliance Score **23.3%**
7 / 30 automated tests passed

Accessibility Issues Found

Page view for about.html showing the page details and Latest Test Results below



The screenshot displays a web application interface for accessibility testing results. At the top, there are filters for 'Errors' (69), 'Warnings' (40), 'High' (10), and 'Medium' (10). Below these are tabs for 'Info' (1), 'Discovery' (8), and 'Low' (10). A list of WCAG standards (1.3.2, 1.3.3, 1.4.1, 1.4.10) and a list of touchpoint groups (Animation, Colors & Contrast, Dialogs & Modals, Event) are also visible. The 'Affected User Groups' section includes icons for Vision, Hearing, Motor, Cognitive, and Seizure. The 'Test User' section shows a 'Guest' user. A 'Quick Search' bar is present. The main section is titled 'Latest Test Results' and shows a test run on 2026-07-21 08:31:32. A prominent red banner indicates 'Errors 69' and states 'Issues that must be fixed for WCAG compliance'. Below this, a section titled 'Accessible Names' is visible, followed by a list of collapsed issue rows, each showing an impact badge, a description, and an XPath.

Latest Test Results showing the red Errors section with 69 errors, an Accessible Names touchpoint group, and collapsed issue rows each showing an impact badge, description, and XPath

Each issue row shows its **impact** (High/Medium/Low), the **user context** it was tested under (e.g. Guest, or a named test-user role), a plain-language description, and the **XPath** locating the element. Issues with multiple occurrences group their instances. Expand a row for the full detail:



Latest Test Results
Tested on 2026-07-21 08:31:32

Errors 69
Issues that must be fixed for WCAG compliance

Accessible Names

2 High An interactive element (button, link, custom widget) has no accessible name derivable from visible text, aria-label, aria-labelledby, alt text, or a <title> child.

> Instance 1: **Guest**
An interactive element (button, link, custom widget) has no accessible name derivable from visible text, aria-label, aria-labelledby, alt text, or a <title> child.
/html[1]/body[1]/main[1]/table[1]/tbody[1]/tr[1]/td[1]/div[1]/p[1]/iframe[1]

> Instance 2: **Guest**
An interactive element (button, link, custom widget) has no accessible name derivable from visible text, aria-label, aria-labelledby, alt text, or a <title> child.
/html[1]/body[1]/main[1]/footer[1]/div[1]/form[1]/input[1]

> High **Guest**
A carousel or slider was detected (rotating slides, prev/next controls), but it lacks role="region" with an accessible name, slide-status announcements, and labelled controls.
/html[1]/body[1]/main[1]/div[2]

> 2 High An element has an onclick handler (or similar JavaScript click listener) but no role, no tabindex, and no keyboard event handlers, so it can be clicked but not activated with a keyboard.

An expanded issue showing two instances of “An interactive element has no accessible name”, each with its own XPath, inside the accordion

Inside an expanded issue you’ll find:

- **What the issue is / Why it matters / Who it affects** — plain-language explanations suitable for sharing with content owners.
- **How to remediate** — concrete fix guidance.
- **WCAG success criteria** — with links to the W3C *Understanding* and *How to Meet* pages.
- **Location** — the XPath, with a copy button.
- **Code snippet** — the offending HTML.
- **Page thumbnail** — the page as it looked at test time.

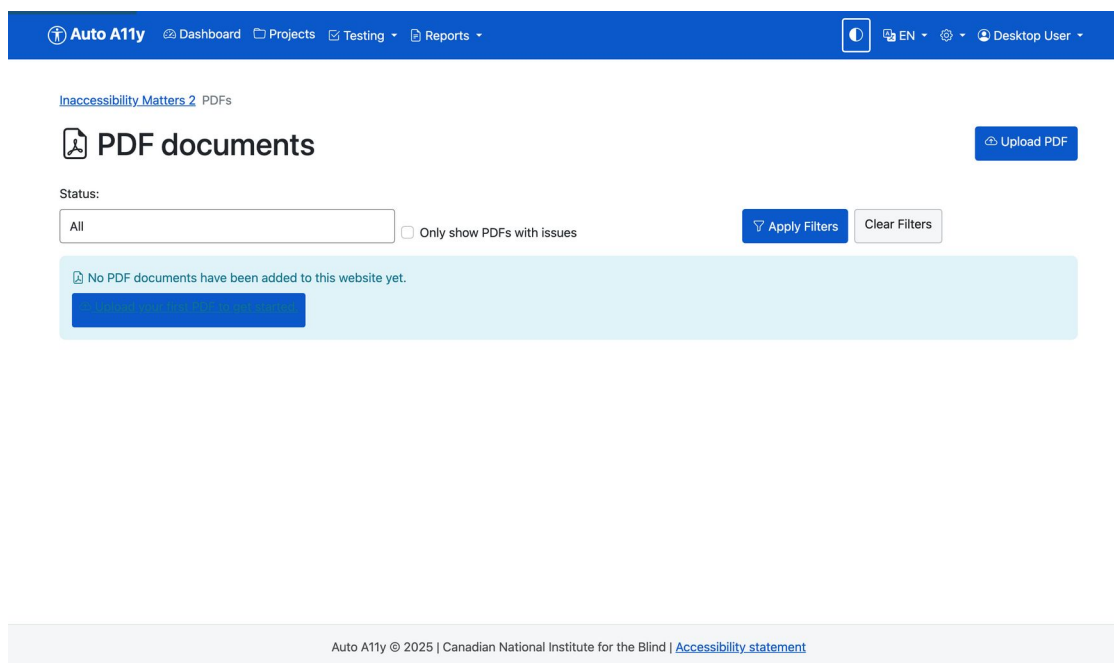
Every page keeps a **Test History** table below the latest results, so you can compare runs over time as fixes land. Pages tested in multiple states or at multiple breakpoints show that context on each issue.



14 Testing PDFs

Accessibility obligations extend to the documents a site links to. Auto A11y audits **PDF** files against PDF/UA (the PDF accessibility standard) and WCAG — checking the tag structure, reading order, document metadata, and more.

PDFs are managed per project (and per website). Open **PDFs** from the project or website page.



PDF documents page with a status filter, an “Only show PDFs with issues” checkbox, and an Upload PDF button; an empty state invites uploading the first PDF

Add a PDF two ways:

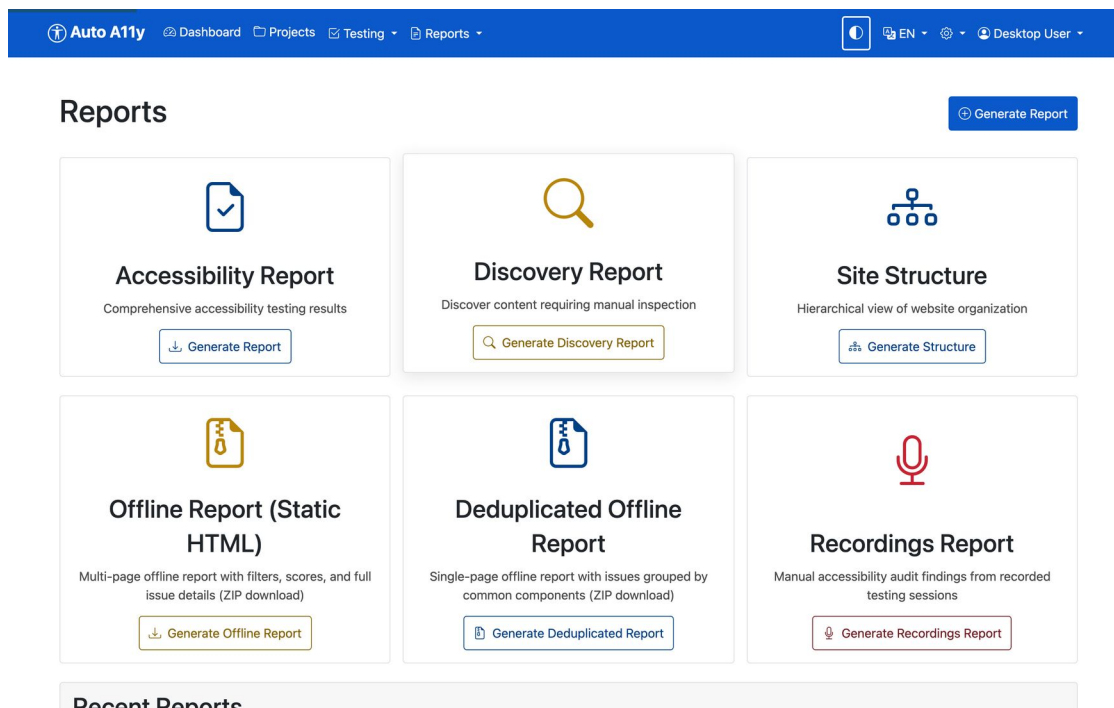
- **Upload PDF** — upload a file from your computer.
- **Fetch by URL** — point Auto A11y at a PDF’s web address and it retrieves it. (Website discovery can also find linked PDFs automatically.)

Once added, start an **audit** on the document. Like page tests, audits run in the background; when complete, the PDF shows its issues (FAIL/WARN counts against the accessibility checks), page images, and an issue map. You can export a self-contained PDF audit report in Markdown or HTML, and filter the PDF list to show only documents with issues.



15 Reports

Open **Reports** in the navigation. Six report types cover different audiences and purposes; all generate in the background and appear under *Recent Reports* when complete.



Reports page showing six cards: Accessibility Report, Discovery Report, Site Structure, Offline Report (Static HTML), Deduplicated Offline Report, and Recordings Report, plus a Generate Report button

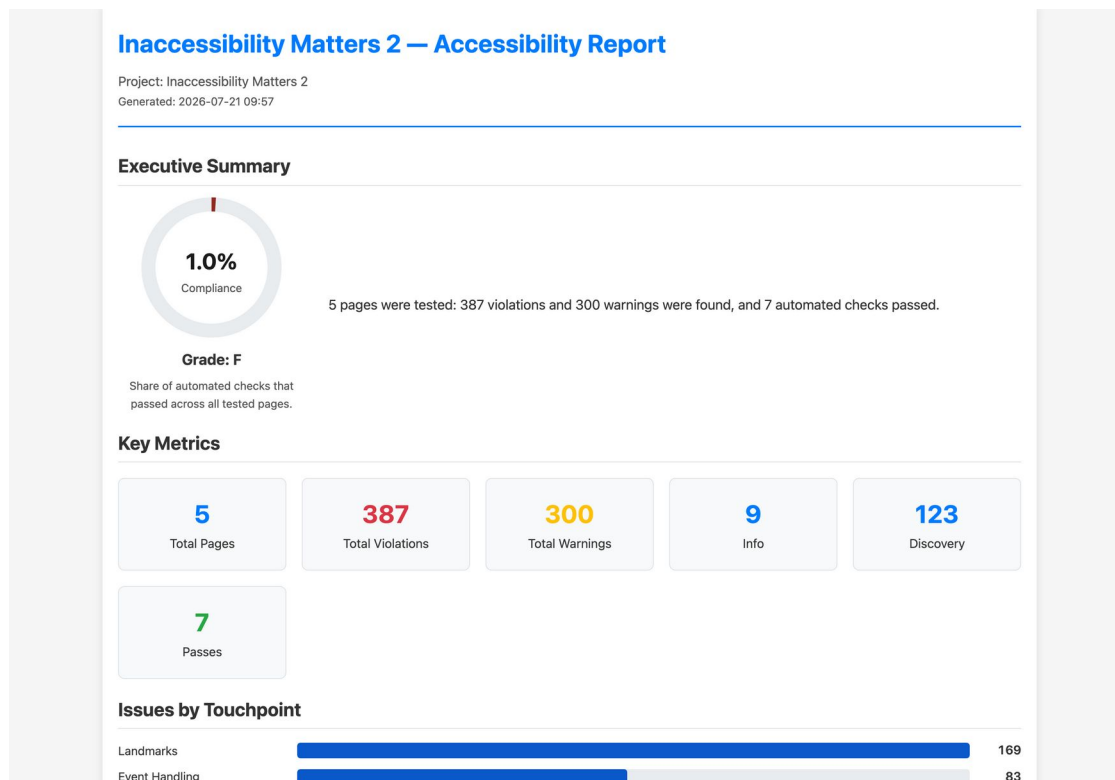
15.1 Accessibility Report

Audience: managers and stakeholders. The executive overview.

A structured summary of a project's (or website's) accessibility state: compliance score with letter grade, key metrics, issues by touchpoint and by impact, the most frequent issues, prioritized recommendations, and an **AI Executive Analysis** — an assessment written by Claude AI covering strengths, critical risks, maturity level, user impact by disability group, legal risk, and a phased remediation strategy.

Available formats: **HTML** (shown below), **Excel**, **CSV**, **JSON**, and **PDF**.





HTML Accessibility Report for Inaccessibility Matters 2 showing the Executive Summary with a 1.0% compliance ring and grade F, Key Metrics cards, and an Issues by Touchpoint bar chart led by Landmarks with 169 issues

The **Excel** format is the working spreadsheet: an executive summary sheet plus per-website sheets and a complete issue list with descriptions, WCAG criteria, XPaths, and remediation guidance — ideal for tracking fixes.



Accessibility Report Summary	
total_pages	5
total_violations	387
total_warnings	300
total_info	9
total_discovery	123
total_passes	7
touchpoint_counts	defaultdict(<class 'int'>, {'accessible_names': 27, 'animation': 15, 'c
wcag_counts	defaultdict(<class 'int'>, {})
impact_counts	defaultdict(<class 'int'>, {'high': 245, 'medium': 363, 'low': 211, 'unk
page_scores	[]
top_issue_codes	Counter({'links_WarnLinkDefaultFocus': 49, 'event_handlers_Disco
project	{'name': 'Inaccessibility Matters 2', 'description': '', 'status': <Project
recordings	[]

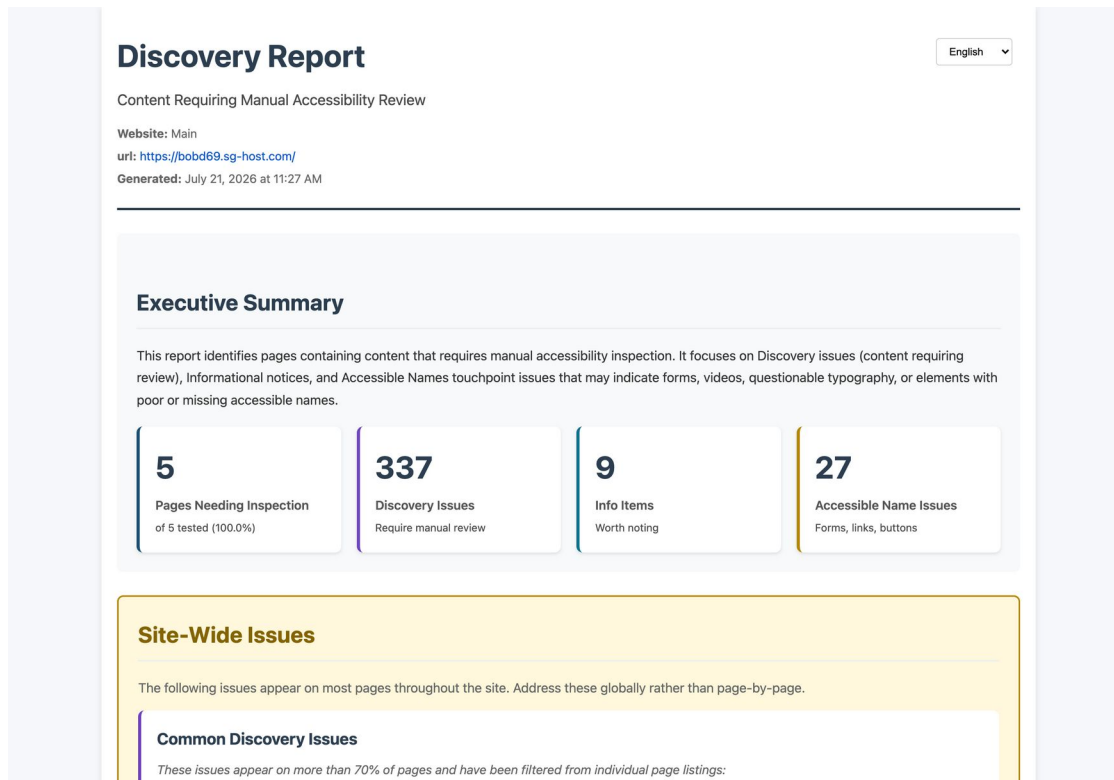
First sheet of the Excel accessibility report showing the executive summary table

15.2 Discovery Report

Audience: auditors planning manual review.



Lists the content that automated testing **cannot** judge — forms, videos, PDFs, unusual typography, elements with questionable accessible names — so a human reviewer knows exactly where to look. Site-wide issues (appearing on most pages) are separated from page-specific ones so global components get fixed once. Formats: HTML or PDF.



Discovery Report for the Main website showing an Executive Summary with cards for 5 Pages Needing Inspection, 337 Discovery Issues, 9 Info Items, and 27 Accessible Name Issues, followed by a Site-Wide Issues section

15.3 Site Structure

Audience: anyone needing to understand the site's shape.

A hierarchical tree of the website's organization as discovered by the crawler, with per-page violation counts — useful for scoping an audit and spotting orphaned sections.



Site Structure Report

Language: EN

Project: Inaccessibility Matters 2
Website: Main (<https://bobd69.sg-host.com/>)
Generated: 2026-07-21 11:27:29

Summary

Total Pages: 5
Tested Pages: 5
Pages with Issues: 5
Total Violations: 387
Total Warnings: 300
Max Depth: 1 levels

Site Structure Tree

▼ bobd69.sg-host.com	(387 total violations)
about.html	(69 total violations)
a11y.html	(65 total violations)
Default.html	(89 total violations)
spain.html	(72 total violations)

Legend

- Directory/Section
- Page
 - Page has been tested
 - Page has accessibility issues
 - Page not yet tested

Expand All Collapse All

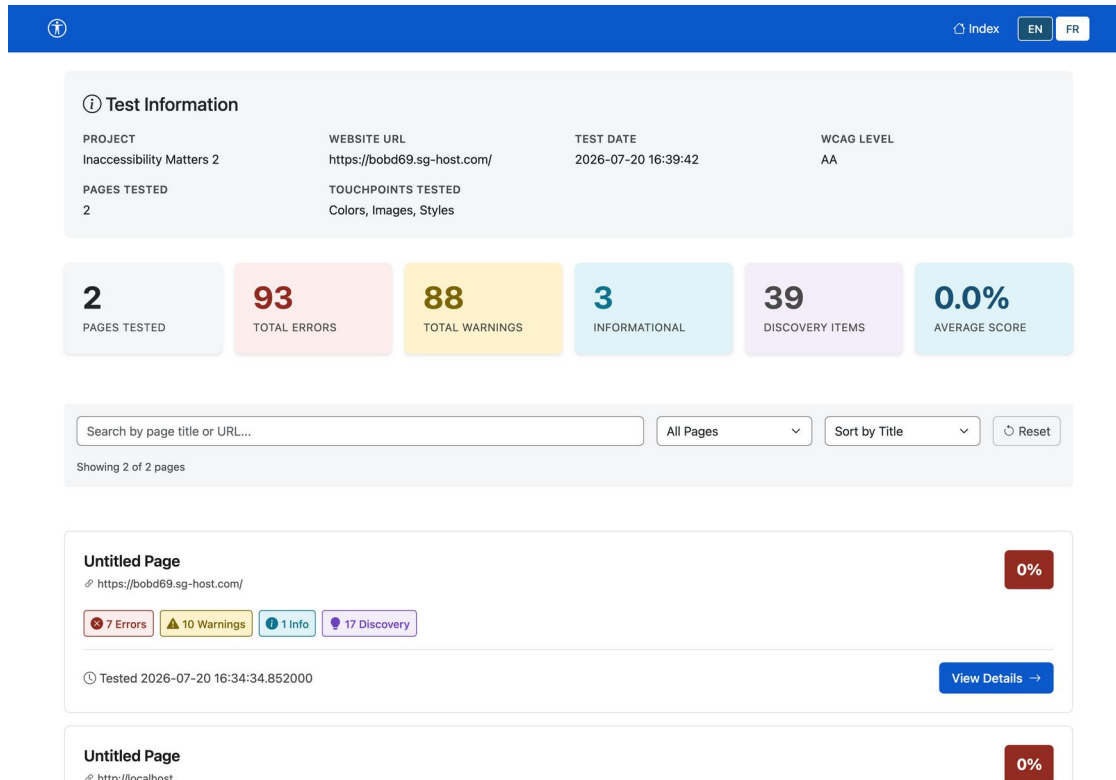
Site Structure Report showing a summary card (5 pages, 387 violations, max depth 1) and the site structure tree with per-page violation counts

15.4 Offline Report (Static HTML)

Audience: clients and teams without access to the app.

A complete, self-contained **multi-page website** delivered as a ZIP: an index of all tested pages with scores and client-side search/filtering, a summary page with statistics, and a full detail page per tested page with the same issue accordions as the app. Everything — CSS, JavaScript, images, screenshots — is bundled, so it works from a file share or email attachment with no server and no internet. Bilingual: every page has an EN/FR switcher.

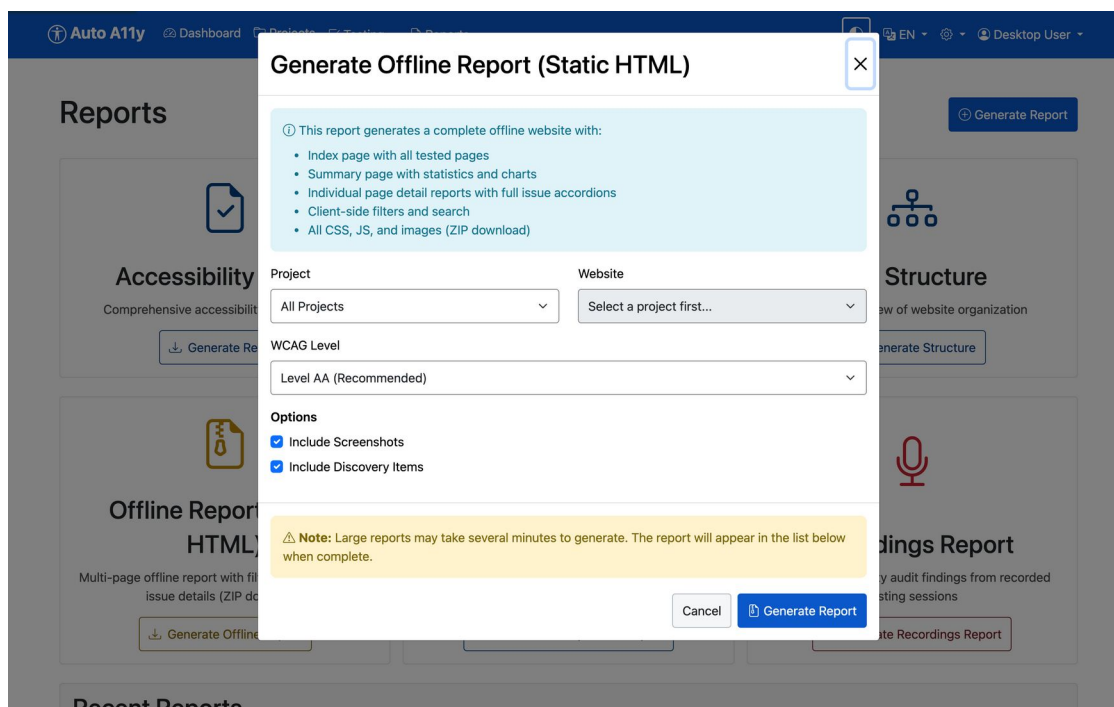




Offline report index showing page cards with scores, issue badges, search and filter controls

Options when generating: choose project or single website scope, WCAG level, and whether to include screenshots and discovery items.





Generate Offline Report dialog listing what the report contains, with Project and Website selectors, WCAG level, and options to include screenshots and discovery items

15.5 Deduplicated Offline Report

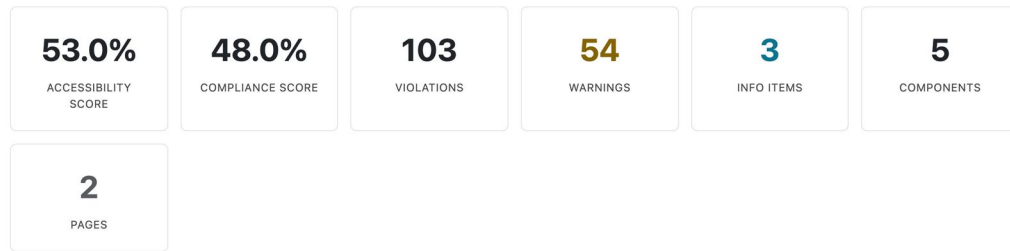
Audience: developers fixing a template-based site.

The same offline ZIP concept, but issues are **grouped by common component** — the header, navigation, and footer that repeat on every page are reported once, with the pages they affect, instead of once per page. Scores are shown both for the full page and excluding component issues, so you can see how much a single template fix will move the needle. Also bilingual.

Deduplicated Accessibility Report

Issues grouped by common components • 2026-07-20 19:04

EN FR



Common Components	
Click a component to view its deduplicated issues	
Navigation header 6be29727	>
2 page(s) ✓ Score: 100.0%	
Navigation 3815c9a1	>
2 page(s) ✓ Score: 100.0%	
Header 48311736	>
2 page(s) ✓ Score: 67.0%	9 violation(s) 3 warning(s)
Footer 1aa066b9	

Deduplicated Accessibility Report showing accessibility and compliance score cards, violation counts, and a Common Components list where each component (navigation, header, footer) shows its pages and score

15.6 Recordings Report

Audience: teams complementing automation with lived experience.

Compiles findings from **recorded manual testing sessions** — audio-recorded walkthroughs by testers with disabilities, uploaded to the project — into an audit document: user quotes with timecodes, pain points, and key takeaways, alongside the structured issues raised. (This example uses the YVR Map project, which has recorded sessions.)



Recordings Report: YVR Map

Generated: 2026-07-21 11:34:04

Executive Summary



Recordings

sam-truncated: YVR Map- Android Talkback- Sam

- ☐ Key Takeaways (17) ▾
- ☐ User Painpoints (23) ▾
- ☐ User Assertions (87) ▾
- ☐ Accessibility Issues (20) ▴

High

Missing heading structure on wayfinding application

3 timecode(s) ▾

High

Website purpose and identity not communicated to screen reader users

2 timecode(s) ▾

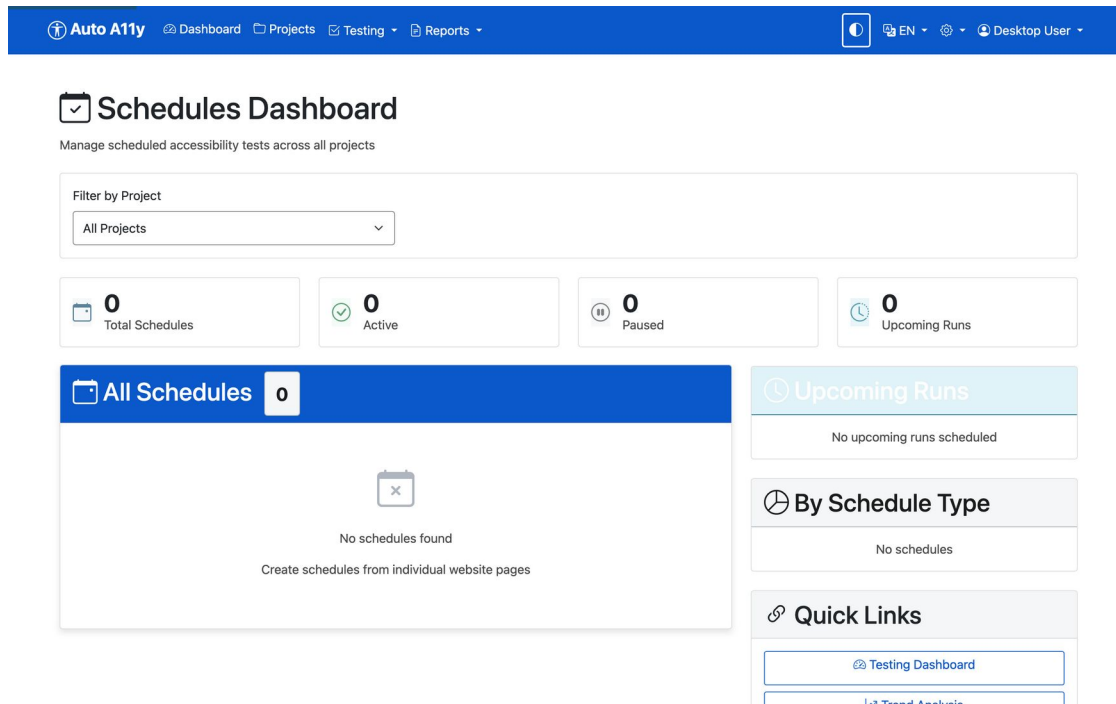
Recordings Report for YVR Map showing executive summary cards (7 recordings, 133 issues by severity) and a recorded session with Key Takeaways, User Painpoints, User Assertions, and Accessibility Issues, each issue with timecodes

15.7 Generating and downloading

Every report generates as a background job — large reports can take several minutes. Finished reports appear in **Recent Reports** at the bottom of the Reports page with a download button; failed jobs can be restarted, and running jobs can be dropped.

16 Scheduling recurring tests

Reports → *Schedules* (or the Schedules button on a website page) lets you run tests automatically — daily, weekly, or monthly — so trend data accumulates without anyone remembering to click Test.



The screenshot shows the 'Schedules Dashboard' in the Auto A11y application. The top navigation bar includes 'Auto A11y', 'Dashboard', 'Projects', 'Testing', and 'Reports'. The dashboard title is 'Schedules Dashboard' with a subtitle 'Manage scheduled accessibility tests across all projects'. A 'Filter by Project' dropdown is set to 'All Projects'. Below this are four summary cards: 'Total Schedules' (0), 'Active' (0), 'Paused' (0), and 'Upcoming Runs' (0). The main content area has a blue header 'All Schedules' with a count of 0. Below the header, it states 'No schedules found' and provides a link to 'Create schedules from individual website pages'. On the right sidebar, there are three sections: 'Upcoming Runs' (No upcoming runs scheduled), 'By Schedule Type' (No schedules), and 'Quick Links' (Testing Dashboard, Trend Analysis).

Schedules page for managing recurring test runs

17 The Testing menu

- **Dashboard** — live and recent test activity across all projects.
- **Configure** — runtime testing options.
- **Fixture Status** — the quality gate: every check in the test suite with its validation state. Only checks passing all fixtures run in production.

Fixture Status page listing accessibility checks and their fixture validation results

- **Trends** — violation and warning counts over time, so you can show progress between audits.

Trend Analysis

All Projects Overview

All Projects Select a project first

View: Daily Weekly Monthly

Period: 7 days 30 days 90 days 1 year

2026-06-21 to 2026-07-21

Filter Trends

Clear All

Issue Type

Violations 0 Warnings 0

Impact Level

High 3229 Medium 3484 Low 6442

WCAG Criteria

WCAG 1.1.1
WCAG 1.2.1
WCAG 1.2.2
WCAG 1.2.3

Touchpoint

Accessible Names (718)
Buttons (303)
Event Handling (253)
Focus Management (2643)

Affected User Groups

Vision Hearing Motor Cognitive Seizure

Total Violations

0

Stable

Total Warnings

0

Tests Run

38

Avg per Test

0.0

Violations & Warnings Over Time

Show Moving Avg

By Impact Level

Trends page with charts of violations and warnings over time



18 Tips, accessibility features, and troubleshooting

The app practices what it audits. The interface meets WCAG 2.2 AA: full keyboard operation (expanded accordions draw a double-line focus ring around the entire issue), dark mode via the toggle in the navigation bar, a full French translation via the EN/FR switcher, and screen-reader-tested components.

The screenshot shows the 'Help & Documentation' section of the Auto A11y application. The top navigation bar is blue with the 'Auto A11y' logo and links to Dashboard, Projects, Testing, and Reports. On the right, there are icons for dark mode, language (EN/FR), and a user profile (Desktop User). The left sidebar under 'Documentation' lists: Understanding Scores (selected), WCAG Standards, Impact Levels, Testing Process, Reports & Exports, FAQ, and About Auto A11y. The main content area is titled 'Help & Documentation' and 'Understanding Your Scores'. It features a light blue box for 'Automated vs Manual Testing Scores' explaining that Auto A11y provides both automated and manual scores. Below this are two columns: 'Automated Testing Scores' (blue header) and 'Manual Testing Scores' (green header). The automated section describes scores generated from scanning tools, listing benefits like speed, code-level checks, and catching 30-40% of issues. The manual section describes scores from human experts, listing benefits like subjective context-aware testing and catching automation misses. At the bottom, a purple box titled 'Why Do I Have Two Different Scores?' explains that each testing type shows two scores: 'Accessibility Score' (percentage of individual checks/issues) and 'WCAG Compliance Score' (percentage of WCAG Success Criteria passed).

Help page

A page loads in the browser but the test reports “Failed to load page”. Usually the page never finishes loading its network activity (hung third-party images, long-polling scripts). Auto A11y tolerates this — it tests the loaded DOM after a grace period — but a page that cannot even reach *domcontentloaded* within 30 seconds will fail. Check the URL is reachable from this machine.

Discovery or testing returns bot-challenge pages instead of content. The site is bot-protected; enable **Stealth Mode** on the project (see [section 9](#)).

Authenticated pages aren’t being tested. Add a **test user** with valid credentials and confirm it with the **Test Login** button (see [section 10](#)).

A check you expected didn’t run. Two possibilities: it’s disabled in the project’s touchpoint configuration (see [section 5](#)), or it hasn’t passed fixture validation — check *Testing* → *Fixture Status*.



AI analysis findings are missing. AI visual analysis is off by default; enable it per project and confirm *AI Analysis: Enabled* on the Dashboard. Remember it incurs API costs and its results can vary between runs (see [section 6](#)).

Report generation seems stuck. Reports over large sites take minutes. The Reports page shows job progress; a stalled job can be dropped and restarted from *Recent Reports*.

The numbers in this guide look alarming. They should — *Inaccessibility Matters* is a demonstration site built to fail. A 1.0% compliance score is the point.



19 Appendix A: Tests by touchpoint

This appendix lists every check in the automated test suite, grouped by touchpoint. Whether a given check runs on a project depends on its fixture-validation status and the project's touchpoint configuration (see [section 5](#)). The AI-assisted analyses (section 6) are separate from this catalog.

The automated test suite contains **213 checks** across **19 touchpoints**. Whether each check runs depends on its fixture-validation status and the project's touchpoint configuration. Types: **Error** (WCAG violation), **Warning** (likely barrier), **Info** (informational), **Discovery** (needs manual review).

19.1 ARIA

Check	Type	What it tests
ErrAriaLabelMayNotBeFoundByVoiceControl	Error	aria-label doesn't match visible text
ErrLabelMismatchOfAccessibleNameAndLabelText	Error	Accessible name doesn't match visible label

19.2 Buttons

Check	Type	What it tests
ErrButtonClipPathWithOutline	Error	Button with non-rectangular clip-path uses outline for focus indicator - outline draws rectangular box not following clipped shape
ErrButtonFocusContrastFail	Error	Button focus outline has insufficient contrast (less than 3:1) against the button's current background color
ErrButtonFocusObscured	Error	Button focus indicator is partially or fully obscured by other elements due to z-index stacking
ErrButtonOutlineOffsetInsufficient	Error	Button focus outline has outline-offset less than 2px, causing the outline to be lost within the button element
ErrButtonOutlineWidthInsufficient	Error	Button focus outline has outline-width less than 2px, making it too thin to be clearly visible



Check	Type	What it tests
ErrButtonSingleSideBoxShadow	Error	Button uses outline:none with box-shadow that only appears on one side (directional shadow with offset)
ErrButtonTransparentOutline	Error	Button focus outline uses semi-transparent color (alpha < 0.5) which cannot guarantee sufficient visibility
WarnButtonDefaultFocus	Warning	Button uses browser default focus outline which may not meet contrast requirements on all backgrounds
WarnButtonFocusGradientBackground	Warning	Button with gradient background has focus outline - contrast cannot be automatically verified against gradient
WarnButtonFocusImageBackground	Warning	Button with background image has focus outline - contrast cannot be automatically verified against image
WarnButtonGenericText	Warning	Button uses generic text like “Click here”, “Submit”, or “OK” without context
WarnButtonOutlineNoneWithBoxShadow	Warning	Button uses outline:none with box-shadow for focus, which may not provide clear indication on all sides

19.3 Colours & Contrast

Check	Type	What it tests
ErrColorRelatedStylesDefinedExplicitlyInElement	Warning	Color-related styles defined inline
ErrColorRelatedStylesDefinedExplicitlyInStyleTag	Warning	Color-related styles defined in style tag
ErrTextContrast	Error	Text color has insufficient contrast ratio with its background color



19.4 Electronic Documents

Check	Type	What it tests
DiscoPDFLinksFound	Discovery	Links to PDF documents detected on page

19.5 Event Handling

Check	Type	What it tests
DiscoFoundJS	Discovery	JavaScript detected on page
ErrorHandlerColorChangeOnly	Error	Element with event handler indicates focus only through color change without structural change
ErrorHandlerFocusContrastFail	Error	Focus indicator on element with event handler has less than 3:1 contrast ratio with adjacent colors
ErrorHandlerNoVisibleFocus	Error	Non-interactive element with event handler (onclick, etc.) lacks a visible focus indicator
ErrorHandlerOutlineNoneNoBoxShadow	Error	Element with event handler removes default outline with 'outline:none' but provides no alternative focus indicator
ErrorHandlerOutlineWidthInsufficient	Error	Element with event handler has a focus outline less than 2 CSS pixels thick
ErrorHandlerSingleSideBoxShadow	Error	Element with event handler uses box-shadow on only one side for focus indicator
ErrorHandlerTransparentOutline	Error	Element with event handler uses semi-transparent (alpha < 0.5) focus outline or box-shadow
ErrTabIndexAriaHiddenFocusable	Error	Element has both tabindex (making it focusable) and aria-hidden='true', which is invalid HTML and creates conflicting accessibility semantics
ErrTabIndexChildOfInt	Error	Child element has tabindex



Check	Type	What it tests
eractive		attribute inside an interactive parent element (button, link, etc.), creating improper structure where assistive technologies cannot properly understand the relationships
ErrTabIndexColorChangeOnly	Error	Element with tabindex indicates focus only through color change without structural change (outline, border, shape)
ErrTabIndexFocusContrastFail	Error	Focus indicator on element with tabindex has less than 3:1 contrast ratio with adjacent colors
ErrTabIndexNoVisibleFocus	Error	Non-interactive element made focusable with tabindex attribute lacks a visible focus indicator
ErrTabIndexOutlineNoneNoBoxShadow	Error	Element with tabindex removes default outline with 'outline:none' but provides no alternative focus indicator
ErrTabIndexOutlineWidthInsufficient	Error	Element with tabindex has a focus outline less than 2 CSS pixels thick
ErrTabIndexSingleSideBoxShadow	Error	Element with tabindex uses box-shadow on only one side (top, right, bottom, or left) for focus indicator
ErrTabIndexTransparentOutline	Error	Element with tabindex uses semi-transparent ($\alpha < 0.5$) focus outline or box-shadow
WarnHandlerDefaultFocus	Warning	Element with event handler has no custom focus styles and relies on browser default focus indicator
WarnHandlerNoBorderOutline	Warning	Element with event handler uses only CSS outline for focus with no border or size change



Check	Type	What it tests
WarnTabIndexDefaultFocus	Warning	Element with tabindex has no custom focus styles and relies on browser default focus indicator
WarnTabIndexNoBorderOutline	Warning	Element with tabindex uses only CSS outline for focus with no border or size change

19.6 Focus Management

Check	Type	What it tests
ErrNegativeTabIndex	Error	Negative tabindex on interactive element
ErrNoOutlineOffsetDefined	Error	No outline offset defined for focus
ErrOutlineIsNoneOnInteractiveElement	Error	Interactive element has CSS outline:none removing the default focus indicator
ErrPositiveTabIndex	Error	Element uses a positive tabindex value (greater than 0)
ErrTabIndexOnNonInteractiveElement	Error	TabIndex attribute on non-interactive element
ErrTabIndexOfZeroOnNonInteractiveElement	Error	tabindex="0" on non-interactive element
ErrWrongTabIndexForInteractiveElement	Error	Inappropriate tabindex on interactive element
ErrZeroOutlineOffset	Error	Outline offset is set to zero

19.7 Fonts & Typography

Check	Type	What it tests
DiscoFontFound	Discovery	Font usage detected for review
WarnFontNotInRecommendedListForAll	Warning	Font not in recommended accessibility list

19.8 Forms

Check	Type	What it tests
DiscoFormOnPage	Discovery	Form detected on page -



Check	Type	What it tests
		needs manual testing
ErrEmptyAriaLabelOnField	Error	Form field has empty aria-label attribute
ErrEmptyAriaLabelledByOnField	Error	Form field has empty aria-labelledby attribute
ErrFieldLabelledBySomethingNotALabel	Error	Field is labeled by an element that is not a proper label
ErrFieldAriaRefDoesNotExist	Error	aria-labelledby references non-existent element
ErrFieldLabelledUsingAriaLabel	Error	Field labeled using aria-label instead of visible label
ErrFieldReferenceDoesNotExist	Error	Label for attribute references non-existent field
ErrFormEmptyHasNoChildNodes	Error	Form element is completely empty with no child nodes
ErrFormEmptyHasNoInteractiveElements	Error	Form has content but no interactive elements
ErrInputBorderChangeInsufficient	Error	Input field border thickens on focus but change is less than 1px (not manifest)
ErrInputFocusColorChangeOnly	Error	Input field focus indicator relies solely on border color change without structural change
ErrInputFocusContrastFail	Error	Input field focus indicator has insufficient color contrast (< 3:1) against background
ErrInputNoVisibleFocus	Error	Text input field has no visible focus indicator (outline:none, no border change, no box-shadow)
ErrInputOutlineWidthInsufficient	Error	Input field focus outline is less than 2px wide
ErrInputSingleSideBoxShadow	Error	Input field uses single-sided box-shadow for focus indicator (does not follow field shape)
ErrLabelContainsMultipleFields	Error	Single label contains multiple form fields



Check	Type	What it tests
ErrOrphanLabelWithNoId	Error	Label element exists but has no for attribute
WarnFieldLabelledByMultipleElements	Warning	Field is labeled by multiple elements via aria-labelledby
WarnInputDefaultFocus	Warning	Input field relies on default browser focus styles which vary across browsers and platforms
WarnInputFocusGradientBackground	Warning	Input field has gradient background - focus indicator contrast cannot be automatically verified
WarnInputFocusOutlineExceedsParent	Warning	Input focus outline extends beyond parent container bounds - outline contrast cannot be automatically verified
WarnInputFocusParentGradientBackground	Warning	Input parent container has gradient background - focus outline contrast cannot be automatically verified
WarnInputFocusParentImageBackground	Warning	Input parent container has background image - focus outline contrast cannot be automatically verified
WarnInputFocusParentZIndexFloating	Warning	Input parent container has z-index without solid background - focus outline contrast cannot be automatically verified
WarnInputFocusZIndexFloating	Warning	Input field has z-index positioning and may float over varying backgrounds - focus outline contrast cannot be automatically verified
WarnInputNoBorderOutline	Warning	Input field uses border/box-shadow changes but no separate outline for focus indicator
WarnInputTransparentFocus	Warning	Input field focus indicator is



Check	Type	What it tests
		semi-transparent (alpha < 0.5) which may not provide sufficient visibility
forms_DiscoNoSubmitButton	Discovery	Form may lack clear submit button
forms_WarnGenericButtonText	Warning	Button has generic text like “Submit” or “Click here”
forms_WarnNoFieldset	Warning	Radio/checkbox group lacks fieldset and legend
forms_WarnRequiredNotIndicated	Warning	Required field not clearly indicated

19.9 Headings

Check	Type	What it tests
ErrEmptyHeading	Error	Heading element (h1-h6) contains no text content or only whitespace
ErrFoundAriaLevelButNoRoleAppliedAtAll	Error	aria-level attribute without role=“heading”
ErrFoundAriaLevelButRoleIsNotHeading	Error	aria-level on element without heading role
ErrHeadingAccessibleNameMismatch	Error	Visible heading text doesn’t match its accessible name
ErrHeadingLevelsSkipped	Error	Heading levels are not in sequential order - one or more levels are skipped (e.g., h1 followed by h3 with no h2)
ErrHeadingOrder	Error	Headings appear in illogical order - high-level headings (H1, H2) appear after lower-level headings (H3, H4, H5, H6)
ErrHeadingsDontStartWithH1	Error	First heading on page is not h1
ErrInvalidAriaLevel	Error	Invalid aria-level value (not 1-6)
ErrMultipleH1HeadingsOnPage	Error	Multiple h1 elements found on page
ErrNoH1OnPage	Error	Page is missing an h1 element



Check	Type	What it tests
ErrNoHeadingsOnPage	Error	to identify the main topic No heading elements (h1-h6) found anywhere on the page
ErrRoleOfHeadingButNoLevelGiven	Error	role="heading" without aria-level
WarnHeadingInsideDisplayNone	Warning	Heading is hidden with display:none
WarnHeadingOver60CharsLong	Warning	Heading text exceeds 60 characters

19.10 Images

Check	Type	What it tests
DiscoFoundInlineSvg	Discovery	Inline SVG element detected that requires manual review to determine appropriate accessibility implementation based on its purpose and complexity
DiscoFoundSvgImage	Discovery	SVG element with role="img" detected that requires manual review to verify appropriate text alternatives are provided
ErrAltOnElementThatDoesntTakeIt	Error	Alt attribute placed on HTML elements that don't support it (such as div, span, p, or other non-image elements), making the alternative text inaccessible to assistive technologies
ErrImageAltContainsHTML	Error	Image's alternative text contains HTML markup tags
ErrImageWithEmptyAlt	Error	Image alt attribute contains only whitespace characters (spaces, tabs, line breaks), providing no accessible name
ErrImageWithImgFileExtensionAlt	Error	Alt text contains image filename with file extension (e.g., "photo.jpg", "IMG_1234.png",



Check	Type	What it tests
ErrImageWithURLAsAlt	Error	“banner.gif”), providing no meaningful description of the image content Alt attribute contains a URL (starting with <code>http://</code> <code>https://</code> <code>www</code> or <code>file://</code> instead of descriptive text about the image content

19.11 Landmarks

Check	Type	What it tests
ErrBannerLandmarkAccessibleNameIsBlank	Error	Banner landmark has blank accessible name
ErrBannerLandmarkHasAriaLabelAndAriaLabelledByAttrs	Error	Banner landmark has both aria-label and aria-labelledby
ErrBannerLandmarkMayNotBeChildOfAnotherLandmark	Error	Banner landmark nested inside another landmark
ErrComplementaryLandmarkAccessibleNameIsBlank	Error	Complementary landmark has blank accessible name
ErrComplementaryLandmarkHasAriaLabelAndAriaLabelledByAttrs	Error	Complementary landmark has both aria-label and aria-labelledby
ErrComplementaryLandmarkMayNotBeChildOfAnotherLandmark	Error	Complementary landmark is nested inside another landmark
ErrCompletelyEmptyNavLandmark	Error	Navigation landmark contains no content
ErrContentInfoLandmarkAccessibleNameIsBlank	Error	Contentinfo landmark has blank accessible name
ErrContentInfoLandmarkHasAriaLabelAndAriaLabelledByAttrs	Error	Contentinfo landmark has both aria-label and aria-labelledby
ErrContentOutsideLandmarks	Error	Content exists outside of landmark regions, making it invisible to screen reader landmark navigation



Check	Type	What it tests
ErrContentinfoLandmarkMayNotBeChildOfAnotherLandmark	Error	Contentinfo landmark is nested inside another landmark
ErrDuplicateLabelForBannerLandmark	Error	Multiple banner landmarks have the same label
ErrDuplicateLabelForComplementaryLandmark	Error	Multiple complementary landmarks have the same label
ErrDuplicateLabelForContentinfoLandmark	Error	Multiple contentinfo landmarks have the same label
ErrDuplicateLabelForFormLandmark	Error	Multiple form landmarks have the same label
ErrDuplicateLabelForNavLandmark	Error	Multiple navigation landmarks have the same label
ErrDuplicateLabelForRegionLandmark	Error	Multiple region landmarks have the same label
ErrDuplicateLabelForSearchLandmark	Error	Multiple search landmarks have the same label
ErrElementNotContainedInALandmark	Error	Content exists outside of any landmark
ErrFormAriaLabelledByIsBlank	Error	Form aria-labelledby references blank or empty element
ErrFormAriaLabelledByReferenceIsHidden	Error	Form aria-labelledby references hidden element
ErrFormAriaLabelledByReferenceDoesNotExist	Error	Form aria-labelledby references non-existent element
ErrFormAriaLabelledByReferenceDoesNotReferenceAHeading	Error	Form aria-labelledby doesn't reference a heading element
ErrFormLandmarkAccessibleNameIsBlank	Error	Form landmark has blank accessible name
ErrFormLandmarkHasAriaLabelAndAriaLabelledByAttrs	Error	Form landmark has both aria-label and aria-labelledby
ErrFormUsesAriaLabelInsteadOfVisibleElement	Error	Form uses aria-label instead



Check	Type	What it tests
t		of visible heading or label
ErrFormUsesTitleAttribute	Error	Form uses title attribute for labeling
ErrMainLandmarkHasAriaLabelAndAriaLabelledByAttrs	Error	Main landmark has both aria-label and aria-labelledby attributes
ErrMainLandmarkHasTabIndexOfZeroCanOnlyHaveMinusOneAtMost	Error	Main landmark has tabindex="0" which is inappropriate
ErrMainLandmarkIsHidden	Error	Main landmark is hidden from view
ErrMainLandmarkMayNotBeChildOfAnotherLandmark	Error	Main landmark nested inside another landmark
ErrMultipleBannerLandmarksOnPage	Error	Multiple banner landmarks found
ErrMultipleContentinfoLandmarksOnPage	Error	Multiple contentinfo landmarks found
ErrMultipleMainLandmarksOnPage	Error	Multiple main landmark regions found on the page
ErrNavLandmarkAccessibleNameIsBlank	Error	Navigation landmark has blank accessible name
ErrNavLandmarkContainsOnlyWhiteSpace	Error	Navigation landmark contains only whitespace
ErrNavLandmarkHasAriaLabelAndAriaLabelledByAttrs	Error	Navigation landmark has both aria-label and aria-labelledby
ErrNestedNavLandmarks	Error	Navigation landmarks are nested
ErrNoBannerLandmarkOnPage	Error	Page is missing a banner landmark to identify the site header region
ErrNoMainLandmarkOnPage	Error	Page is missing a main landmark region to identify the primary content area
ErrRegionLandmarkHasAriaLabelAndAriaLabelledByAttrs	Error	Region landmark has both aria-label and aria-labelledby
RegionLandmarkAccessibleNameIsBlank	Error	Region landmark has blank



Check	Type	What it tests
WarnBannerLandmarkAccessibleNameUsesBanner	Warning	accessible name Banner landmark uses generic term “banner” in label
WarnComplementaryLandmarkAccessibleNameUsesComplementary	Warning	Complementary landmark label uses generic term “complementary”
WarnComplementaryLandmarkHasNoLabel	Warning	Complementary landmark lacks a label
WarnContentInfoLandmarkHasNoLabel	Warning	Contentinfo landmark lacks a label
WarnContentInfoLandmarkAccessibleNameUsesContentInfo	Warning	Contentinfo landmark uses generic term “contentinfo” in label
WarnFormLandmarkAccessibleNameUsesForm	Warning	Form landmark uses generic term “form” in label
WarnHeadingFoundInLandmarkButIsLabelledByAnAriaLabelledBy	Error	Landmark has heading but uses different element for label
WarnHeadingFoundInsideLandmarkButDoesntLabelLandmark	Warning	Heading inside landmark doesn’t label the landmark
WarnMultipleBannerLandmarksButNotAllHaveLabels	Warning	Multiple banner landmarks exist but not all have labels
WarnMultipleComplementaryLandmarksButNotAllHaveLabels	Warning	Multiple complementary landmarks but not all labeled
WarnMultipleContentInfoLandmarksButNotAllHaveLabels	Warning	Multiple contentinfo landmarks exist but not all have labels
WarnMultipleNavLandmarksButNotAllHaveLabels	Warning	Multiple navigation landmarks but not all labeled
WarnMultipleRegionLandmarksButNotAllHaveLabels	Warning	Multiple region landmarks but not all labeled
WarnNavLandmarkAccessibleNameUsesNavigation	Warning	Navigation landmark uses generic term “navigation” in label
WarnNavLandmarkHasNoLabel	Warning	Navigation landmark lacks



Check	Type	What it tests
label		label
WarnNoContentinfoLandmarkOnPage	Warning	Page is missing a contentinfo landmark to identify the footer region
WarnNoNavLandmarksOnPage	Warning	Page has no navigation landmarks to identify navigation regions
WarnRegionLandmarkAccessibleNameUsesNavigation	Warning	Region landmark incorrectly uses “navigation” in its label
WarnRegionLandmarkHasNoLabelSoIsNotConsideredALandmark	Warning	Region landmark lacks required label to be considered a landmark

19.12 Language

Check	Type	What it tests
ErrElementPrimaryLangNotRecognized	Error	Element has unrecognized language code
ErrElementRegionQualifierNotRecognized	Error	Element lang attribute has unrecognized region qualifier
ErrEmptyLanguageAttribute	Error	Element (non-HTML) has a lang attribute present but with no value (lang=“”), preventing screen readers from determining language changes
ErrEmptyXmlLangAttr	Error	xml:lang attribute is empty
ErrHreflangAttrEmpty	Error	hreflang attribute is empty on link
ErrHreflangNotOnLink	Error	hreflang attribute on non-link element
ErrIncorrectlyFormattedPrimaryLang	Error	Language code incorrectly formatted
ErrPrimaryHrefLangNotRecognized	Error	hreflang language code not recognized
ErrPrimaryLangAndXmlLangMismatch	Error	lang and xml:lang attributes don’t match
ErrPrimaryLangUnrecognized	Error	Language code not recognized



Check	Type	What it tests
ErrPrimaryXmlLangUnrecognized	Error	xml:lang language code not recognized
ErrRegionQualifierForHreflangUnrecognized	Error	hreflang region qualifier not recognized
ErrRegionQualifierForPrimaryLangNotRecognized	Error	Region qualifier in primary language code not recognized (e.g., “en-XY”)
ErrRegionQualifierForPrimaryXmlLangNotRecognized	Error	Region qualifier in xml:lang not recognized

19.13 Links

Check	Type	What it tests
ErrAnchorTargetTabIndex	Error	In-page link target (element with id referenced by href="#id") is not keyboard accessible - non-interactive element needs tabindex="-1"
ErrDocumentLinkMissingFileType	Error	Link to downloadable document (PDF, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, etc.) does not indicate the file type in its accessible name
ErrDocumentLinkWrongLanguage	Error	Link to a downloadable document in a different language than the page language lacks lang attribute or language indication
ErrLinkButtonMissingSpaceHandler	Error	Link is styled to look like a button but lacks Space key handler - keyboard users expect Space key to activate button-like elements
ErrLinkColorChangeOnly	Error	Link focus indicator relies solely on color change without outline, border, box-shadow, or underline
ErrLinkFocusContrastFail	Error	Link focus indicator (outline, border, or underline) has contrast ratio < 3:1 against



Check	Type	What it tests
ErrLinkImageNoFocusIndicator	Error	the background Image link has no visible focus indicator (no outline, border, or box-shadow)
ErrLinkOpensNewWindowNoWarning	Error	Link opens in new window/tab without warning users
ErrLinkOutlineWidthInsufficient	Error	Link focus outline width is less than 2px
ErrLinkTextNotDescriptive	Error	Link text does not adequately describe the link's destination or purpose
WarnColorOnlyLink	Warning	Link in flowing text is distinguished from surrounding text only by color, without underline, border, or other non-color visual indicator
WarnColorOnlyLinkWeakIndicator	Warning	Link in flowing text uses only subtle visual indicators (font-weight, bold, or text-shadow) in addition to color - these can be difficult for users to recognize as links
WarnLinkDefaultFocus	Warning	Link uses browser default focus styles which vary across browsers and may fail contrast requirements
WarnLinkFocusGradientBackground	Warning	Link has gradient background - focus indicator contrast cannot be automatically verified and requires manual testing
WarnLinkLooksLikeButton	Warning	Link is styled to look like a button but uses anchor element
WarnLinkOutlineOffsetTooLarge	Warning	Link has both underline and outline with outline-offset > 1px, creating confusing visual gap



Check	Type	What it tests
WarnLinkTransparentOutline	Warning	Link focus outline or border uses semi-transparent color (alpha < 0.5) which cannot guarantee sufficient contrast
WarnMissingDocumentMetadata	Warning	Link to downloadable document does not provide additional metadata such as file size or page count

19.14 Lists

Check	Type	What it tests
ErrListitemEmpty	Error	List item (or role="listitem") is empty or contains only whitespace, providing no content for users

19.15 Navigation

Check	Type	What it tests
ErrNoCurrentPageIndicatorMagnification	Error	Navigation lacks visual current page indicator, preventing screen magnifier users from knowing their location without panning
ErrNoCurrentPageIndicatorScreenReader	Error	Navigation lacks aria-current="page" indicator, forcing screen reader users through entire menu to discover current location

19.16 Page

Check	Type	What it tests
ErrEmptyPageTitle	Error	Page title element is empty
ErrMissingDocumentType	Error	HTML document is missing the DOCTYPE declaration (<!DOCTYPE html>) at the beginning of the file
ErrMultiplePageTitles	Error	Multiple title elements found in document head causing unpredictable behavior



Check	Type	What it tests
ErrNoPageTitle	Error	Page has no <title> element in the document head

19.17 Page Title

Check	Type	What it tests
ErrEmptyTitleAttr	Error	Empty title attribute
ErrIframeWithNoTitleAttr	Error	Iframe element is missing the required title attribute
ErrImproperTitleAttribute	Error	Title attribute used in particularly problematic patterns (on non-focusable elements or duplicating visible text)
ErrTitleAttrFound	Error	Title attribute used - fundamentally inaccessible to assistive technology
WarnVagueTitleAttribute	Warning	Title attribute contains vague or generic text that provides no useful information

19.18 Responsive & Reflow

Check	Type	What it tests
DiscoResponsiveBreakpoints	Discovery	Responsive breakpoints detected on page

19.19 Styles

Check	Type	What it tests
DiscoStyleAttrOnElements	Discovery	Inline styles detected
DiscoStyleElementOnPage	Discovery	Style element found in page
ErrStyleAttrColorFont	Error	Inline style attributes define color or font properties directly on HTML elements, overriding user stylesheets and preventing users from customizing visual presentation
ErrStyleTagColorFont	Error	Style tags in HTML



Check	Type	What it tests
		document define color or font properties, making it harder for users to override with custom stylesheets due to specificity and source order
WarnStyleAttrOther	Warning	Inline style attributes define layout properties (margin, padding, width, display) directly on HTML elements instead of using CSS classes
WarnStyleTagOther	Warning	Style tags in HTML document define layout properties, which should preferably be in external CSS files for better maintainability and performance

See also: [API_GUIDE.md](#) for automating Auto A11y from scripts and CI, and [ARCHITECTURE.md](#) for how the platform works internally.

